SOP-2002
Crisis Response Procedures

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Approvals

The signatures below certify that this procedure has been reviewed and accepted, and demonstrates that the signatories are aware of all the requirements contained herein and are committed to ensuring their provision.

	Name	Signature	Position	Date
Prepared by	James Kaplan	Signed on Original	Compliance Manager	23/11/23
Approved by	Pavel Shparber	Signed on Original	CEO	23/11/23

Amendment Record

This procedure is reviewed to ensure its continuing relevance to the systems and process that it describes. A record of contextual additions or omissions is given below:

Page No.	Context	Revision	Date

Contents

CONTENTS **3**

SOP-2002 CRISIS RESPONSE PROCEDURES **4**

1. INTRODUCTION & PURPOSE 4
2. REFERENCES 4
3. TERMS & DEFINITIONS 4
4. APPLICATION & SCOPE 4
5. REQUIREMENTS 4
6. EXERCISES 5
7. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES 5
8. COMMUNICATION WITH STAKEHOLDERS 5
9. PROCESS 6

APPENDIX A – CONTACTS 7
APPENDIX B – LOSS OF PRIMARY OPERATING SITE (NETANYA) 8
APPENDIX C - PIRACY INCIDENT 9
APPENDIX D - NEGATIVE PR EVENT 10
APPENDIX E - MAJOR INJURY OR DEATH OF AN EMPLOYEE 11

SOP-2002 Crisis Response Procedures

1. Introduction & Purpose

A crisis is characterised as an extreme threat to important values, with intense time pressures, high stress, and the need for rapid but careful decision making. It is often a turning point in which a situation of impending danger to the organization runs the risk of escalating in intensity, interfering with normal business operations, jeopardizing the organization's public image, and damaging the bottom line. Either a sudden event or a long smouldering issue may trigger a crisis. It is essential that we maintain an established and validated process to manage any conceptualized crisis, so as to limit the intensity of a negative threat or event to our employees, products, services, financial condition and reputation.

2. References

Reference	Description
M-2001	The organisation Security Management Manual
M-2002	Risk Management Manual

3. Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition
Crisis	An extreme threat to the organisation's supply chain
CRT	Crisis Response Team – A team of experts and members of Senior Management appointed to manage the crisis.

4. Application & Scope

The scope of this procedure encompasses all business conducted by the organisation in the provision of a private contracted maritime security service.

The following incidents are, for the purposes of this Procedure, regarded as Crises:

1. Loss of primary operating site (Netanya) (Appendix B)
2. Piracy Incident (Appendix C)
3. Any negative PR event (Appendix D)
4. Major injury or death of an employee (Appendix E)

The specific procedure for each of these incidents can be viewed at the relevant appendices.

5. Requirements

The organisation employs an IMS within which there is a requirement to maintain a procedure to deal with:

- assuring means of communication during times of pressure and disruption with regular testing of communications for such circumstances;
- clear policies and protocols for communicating with the media and internet based networks with clear understanding as to lines of authority for such communications within;

6. Exercises

In order to maintain the preparedness of the organisation to deal with a crisis and to test and maintain the continued effectiveness of these procedures, an exercise is to be conducted every 6 months, within which one of the procedures contained in the Appendices is tested.

The results are to be recorded on form F-2017, Crisis Response Exercise Report, analysed at the next Management Review Meeting and the procedures modified if necessary.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

Upon identifying that an incident falls within the scope of this SOP, the Ops Center will activate the Crisis Response Team (CRT). The deputy (in case of absence) is shown in brackets.

Position	Role	Responsibility
CEO (CFO)	Crisis Management Leader	Mobilise and Lead CRT Initial Evaluation/Risk Analysis Authorise any location moves Authorise emergency purchases
COO (CFO)	Operational Manager Business Continuation Mgr	Follow SOP's Act to contain incident On-site management of resources Manage move to new location if necessary
Compliance Officer (CFO)	Comms Manager Post-Incident Actions	Communicate with Media and Employees Communicate with authorities and key stakeholders Contain information (social media etc) Debrief, Record, Analyse, Report, Amend
Ops Mgr (TBD)	Incident Initial Response	Evaluate incident for crisis applicability Activate CRT Operational continuation

8. Communication with Stakeholders

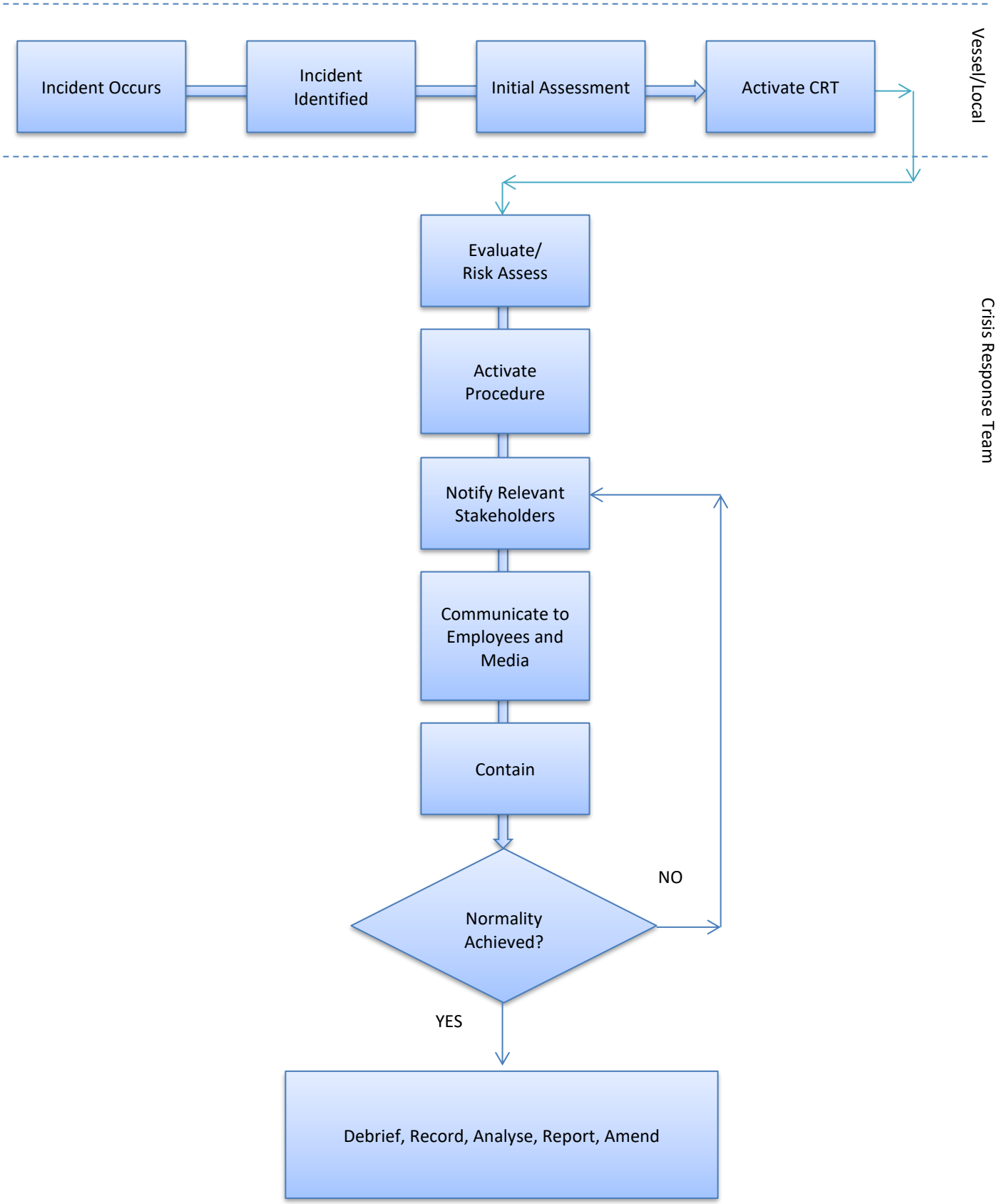
Consult table below for details of those stakeholders that should be considered for contact in the event of an incident within the scope of this SOP. The list is not mandatory, nor is it exhaustive. Final decision to notify the relevant stakeholder should be decided by the Compliance Officer.

Stakeholder	Loss of Site	Piracy	PR Event	Injury/Death	
Client	x	x		x	
PCASP	x	x			
Insurers	x	x		x	
Local Governments	x		x	x	
Flag States	x	x		x	
LRQA	x	x	x	x	
MSS Global	x	x	x	x	
Local Authorities	x			x	
Suppliers	x				

See also contact list at Appendix A.

9. Process Diagram

The response to the incident will follow the general process diagram below:



Appendix A – Contacts

For contact details of SMS employees, see information contained within Opcen

Name	Title	Company	Details
Christina Blyth	PR Officer	LRQA (UK)	**T** +44 (0)24 7688 2213 **F** +44 (0)24 7630 2662 **E** christina.blyth@lrqa.com
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Appendix B – Loss of Primary Operating Site (Birkirkara)

The organisation's prime administrative and operational site (Opcen) is located Birkirkara, Malta.

All operations are continually recorded and SMS data is stored 'in the cloud'. In the event of damage to the prime site from hurricane, fire, earthquake, pandemic or any other uncontrollable major incident, the operational and administrative staff would be relocated to the alternate location within 24 hours. All command, control and communications functions would be maintained during the transition by employing staging strategies and the use of mobile computing and communicating devices.

Alternate site: 96 Dimitriou Gounari Str. & Kifisias Av. Marousi , Athens, Greece

Procedure

1. Ensure all personnel are safe from harm
2. Notify relevant stakeholders
3. Set up initial crisis response centre in local hotel
4. Contact Telecoms provider and divert all phones to mobile phones of key personnel.
5. Deploy 2 personnel as advance team to alternate site to prepare Ops Center
6. Recover any usable resources from Birkirkara Ops Center
7. When advance team report alternate site is ready, move remainder of Operations and Management Team to alternate site.
8. Debrief, record, analyse, report and amend procedures where necessary

Appendix C - Piracy Incident

The procedures to be followed when the organisation is involved in a Piracy incident are:

- SOP-3005 - Incident Managing And Reporting
- SOP-3001 - Embarked Team Procedures

Additional (Ops Center) Procedures

1. Notify relevant stakeholders
2. Set up initial crisis response centre in Ops Center
3. Debrief, record, analyse, report and amend procedures where necessary

Appendix D - Negative PR Event

Crises are taken as a threat to the organisation as they can damage our reputation which ultimately can affect how stakeholders interact with us. Post-crisis communication can be used to repair the reputation and/or prevent reputational damage.

The physical and psychological needs of the stakeholders is the top priority in a crisis but once these stakeholder needs have been addressed, the crisis management team can turn their attention to other demands such as the organisation's reputation.

Procedure

1. Ensure all personnel are safe from harm
2. Set up initial crisis response centre in Ops Center
3. Consider need to tell all employees not to communicate with anyone about the issue
4. Prevent incident information spread through social media
5. Communicate with relevant stakeholders
6. Debrief, record, analyse, report and amend procedures where necessary

Holding Statements

There may be times when personnel are approached by the media unexpectedly and may be pressurised into making a statement. If such a situation occurs, personnel are to use one of the following statements:

"We have implemented our crisis response plan, which places the highest priority on the health and safety of our people."

"Our hearts and minds are with those who are in harm's way, and we hope that they are well."

"We will be supplying additional information when it is available and posting it on our website."

Appendix E - Major Injury or Death of an Employee

The procedure is to be followed for the serious injury or death of an employee.

1. If any of the MST become casualties, the Team Leader will send a Serious Incident Report (form F-3001) to the Ops Center. On receipt of this report the Ops Center will carry out the reporting procedures detailed below.
2. The COO must be informed **immediately** upon receipt of a report of an MST casualty and the CEO and CFO informed as quickly as is practically possible.
3. Due to the sensitive nature of such an incident, details of any part of the casualty report are not to be disclosed to anyone outside of the SMS Ops Center.
4. Incident management is the responsibility of the MST and that the immediate tactical considerations of any initial response take precedence over reporting. However, the passage of information is essential if the correct support is to be provided, and every effort is to be made to provide accurate and timely reports.
5. The Ops Center are to do everything possible to support the affected MST and to plan the safe handling of the casualty, including helping to arrange Medevac.

REPORTING

The following forms are to be completed in the event of an operational casualty. They are to be produced in support of any subsequent enquiry:

(a) Witness Statement(s) (F-1044)

(b) Incident Report (F-3001)

INCIDENT OPERATIONAL MANAGER

In the event of a casualty or death, the Incident Operational Manager is responsible for the following actions:

(a) Notifying CEO and CFO of any casualty evacuation requirement.

(b) Arrange Medevac of casualty

(c) Compile all reports

(d) Maintain close liaison between CEO, the Ops Center, the MST Team Leader and the Client Company (operator of the vessel)

(e) Ensure completed reports are sent to CFO for onward delivery to Insurance Company

Additional (Ops Center) Procedures

1. Notify relevant stakeholders
2. Set up initial crisis response centre in Ops Center
3. Debrief, record, analyse, report and amend procedures where necessary

Appendix F – Imminent ship seizure attempt

In the unlikely event that the MST cannot prevent a boarding, the following measures are to be executed in coordination with the Master and crew:

1. The MST Leader (MSTL) is responsible for swiftly relocating personnel not in the Citadel to that secure location. The MSTL should determine the last safe moment for the bridge team to evacuate internally to the Citadel.
2. The announcement "LOCKDOWN, LOCKDOWN, LOCKDOWN" should be broadcasted over the vessel's P.A. system and on the radio to the Citadel.
3. In the event of a Bridge Team Lockdown, MST should stay on the prepared and covered positions ready to use lethal force.
4. The Bridge team is to move collectively from the Bridge to the Citadel, led by a designated assigned In-Charge (I.C) Officer, acting as the 'last man.' The Officer is responsible for closing and locking/jamming all doors leading to the Citadel.
5. The assigned In-Charge (I.C) Officer of the Citadel should be ready at the entrance, aware of the team's arrival, and provided with the necessary password.
6. Upon arrival at the Citadel, an immediate roll call should be conducted to ensure the safety of all crew members. In case of crew capture, it should be assumed that the pirates have full control of the ship.
7. The MST is to assist the Master in utilizing Citadel communications to summon coalition support and liaise with the Seagull Ops team.
8. The MST plays a vital role in reassuring and guiding crew members experiencing shock, providing support during a stressful situation.
9. The MST should mentor the crew for actions during military intervention and actions during kidnapping.

BEHAVIOUR IN CASE OF IMMINENT SEIZURE OR MILITARY INTERVENTION

1. MST must identify assets, by attackers and to allocate prepared positions in accordance to M-3001 cl.27.
2. MSTL is responsible to give orders on opening fire and relocate team members.
3. Visual and acoustic signals must be given to the attackers, identified the presence of armed guards onboard.
4. No standing upright and\or showing weapons above head. This increases potential impact surface from stray bullet.
5. Usage of the lethal force must be in accordance to SOP-3004 RUF.

ACTION DURING HIJACK/HOSTAGE

1. Maintain calmness.
2. Keep hands visible and fully comply.
3. Avoid taking photographs.
4. Do not engage.
5. Avoid being confrontational.
6. Cooperate fully.
7. Lay face down flat on the floor.
8. Place both hands behind the head and keep them visible to the Assault Team.
9. Refrain from sudden movements.
10. Comply with the commands of the Assault Team.
11. Be prepared to answer questions on identity and status onboard.
12. Prepare the cover story, which should be same across all members of MST.
13. Recognize that all personnel will be treated as potential threats until identities are established.
14. Acknowledge that English may not be the working language of all naval units in the region.
15. Strictly avoid using cameras during any military action.
16. Focus on maintaining control and assessing the developing situation.

17. Control natural 'fight or flight' responses and manage feelings of fear and anxiety.
18. Avoid antagonizing abductors to prevent severe consequences.
19. Minimize rapid movements, as abductors may be nervous.
20. Psychologically prepare for physical and mental hardship to mitigate the shock of capture.
21. Strive to establish rapport with abductors and accept their new leadership.
22. Adopt a positive mental attitude individually and as a team from the outset.